
Bank of Jamaica

Evacuation Procedures - Nethersole Place

The following procedures should be strictly observed in order to ensure the security and safety of all members of staff, pensioners, visitors, contractors and customers, should there be the need to evacuate the building resulting from natural or man-made disasters.

Staff Responsibilities:

1. Familiarize yourself with your surroundings, inclusive of the location of the first aid kit, fire extinguisher, exit doors, evacuation routes, and assembly point.
2. Remain aware and alert, and be prepared to evacuate the building at the sound of an alarm or an evacuation advisory.
3. Ensure that all important documents are securely locked away when not in use.
4. Personal belongings should be kept in a state of readiness for easy retrieval at all times.
5. At the sound of the alarm or an evacuation announcement, move to the nearest exit or fire escape without delay.
6. DO NOT USE the elevators during an evacuation.
7. ALWAYS use the designated stairwells to exit the building.
8. If a stairway is filled with smoke or is crowded, use an alternative stairway.
9. Safely descend the stairs in single files, keeping to the left and using the handrails.
10. Keep the opposite (right) side for fire officers and other emergency personnel.
11. Descend swiftly but safely to minimize the risk of accidents and stampedes.
12. Once outside, make your way across the road away from the building and proceed to the designated assembly area in the UDC Car Park at the **furthest point** (Eastern End) away from the building. Remain there and await further instructions from Floor Wardens or members of the Emergency Management team. **DO NOT** re-enter the building until it has been declared safe.
13. Do not attempt to remove motor vehicles from the parking spaces.

Floor Wardens should:

1. Be knowledgeable of the persons in attendance at work at all times.
2. Be knowledgeable of the persons with special needs/ailment that may require assistance during an evacuation.
3. Conduct an inspection of the medical and emergency kits to ensure contents/supplies are appropriate, adequate, and sufficient.
4. Be prepared at all times to instruct both staff and visitors on the proper evacuation procedures should the need arise.
5. On the sound of the alarm or receipt of an evacuation advisory, ensure that all exit doors, including fire escapes, are promptly opened to allow unrestricted movement for everyone.
6. Put on your Personal Protective Equipment.
7. Instruct members of staff to exit the building without delay while simultaneously directing them toward the nearest fire escape or exit doors.
8. Check all offices workspaces, bathrooms, lounges and kitchen area to ensure they are vacated.
9. Depart the building with the attendance register(s), medical and emergency kits as well as the hand-held fire extinguishers.
10. Assist in maintaining the safe and orderly descent of the stairs. Remind persons to always use the handrails and ensure that the pathways along the core walls remain clear for emergency personnel.
11. Collect a punctuality report from the Shift Commander's Desk prior to proceeding to the assembly point.
12. Assist individuals in safely crossing the road towards the designated assembly point.
13. At the assembly point, conduct a roll call to ensure all staff members are accounted for. Notify the emergency personnel of any unaccounted persons.
14. Report any safety hazards or related concerns to the Contingency Officer/Disaster and Emergency Manager, or any other member of the emergency team.

Protection Officers Responsibilities

1. The Protection Officer at this location has the responsibility to manage the safe and secure evacuation of the building.
2. At the sound of the alarm ensure that all exit doors are opened, the escalators are turned off, access restricted and elevators grounded.
3. Confer with Floor Wardens and other Emergency Officials to ensure that all members of staff and visitors evacuate the building and are accounted for at the assembly point.
4. Ensure that persons are prevented from entering the building during evacuation and that all entrance/exit doors are securely locked.
5. Ensure that the building is empty by conducting a final sweep of all floors inclusive of offices, lounge areas and bathroom facilities before exiting and advise Emergency Officials accordingly.

